



Although humans have discovered many strong metals and useful elements, gold has remained one of the most valuable. Before people knew what it was, they saw glittering gold dust in river beds or dug large gold nuggets out from rocks. They found that gold has many valuable qualities: it is soft enough to hammer into any shape and can be melted down for moulding

into ornaments. Best of all, its gleaming golden colour never fades away. Ancient cultures prized items made of gold: in ancient Egypt, gold was used to make coins as well as to cap the tops of pyramids. Gold is, however, so rare that if all the world's mined gold were forged into a cube, it would fit inside the penalty area of a soccer pitch.